

Adrian Sauter

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First-year PhD student in AI Safety and Cognitively Inspired Machine Learning at Helmholtz Munich, supervised by Dr. Eric Schulz. I combine academic research, industry experience, and interdisciplinary thinking to develop AI systems that are safe, interpretable, and aligned with human values.

EDUCATION

Helmholtz Institute for Human-Centered AI <i>PhD in AI Safety</i> Supervisor: Dr. Eric Schulz (Helmholtz Munich)	Munich, Germany 05/2026 – Present
University of Amsterdam <i>MSc in Artificial Intelligence (cum laude)</i> Thesis: Contextual Sensitivity of Moral Beliefs in Large Language Models	Amsterdam, Netherlands 09/2023 – 05/2026
University of Tuebingen <i>BSc in Cognitive Science</i> Thesis: Video Background Extraction with a Masked-Autoencoder-Based Neural Network	Tuebingen, Germany 10/2019 – 07/2023

EXPERIENCE

KPN Amsterdam <i>Research & Development Intern for XAI</i> Researched Explainable AI for Customer Call Classification through Concept-Bottleneck Models using LLMs.	Amsterdam, Netherlands 02/2025 – 08/2025
University of Amsterdam <i>Teaching Assistant</i> Led tutorials and seminars for graduate courses, instructing and supervising 30-200 students.	Amsterdam, Netherlands 09/2024 – 02/2026
ELLIS Unit Amsterdam <i>Project Assistant</i> Contributed to the planning and communication of projects that are supported and organized by ELLIS.	Amsterdam, Netherlands 04/2024 – 08/2024
Neuro-Cognitive Modeling Group <i>Research Assistant</i> Provided technical consultancy for professors associated with the lab, graded assignments.	Tuebingen, Germany 03/2023 – 08/2023
Leibniz-Institute for Knowledge Media Research <i>Research Assistant</i> Supervised in-person psychological experiments and helped analyzing the obtained data.	Tuebingen, Germany 12/2021 – 10/2022

PUBLICATIONS/ PREPRINTS

- Sauter, A.**, Pemmasani Prabakaran, R.S., Miletić, M., & Ott, R. (2024). "Studying How to Efficiently and Effectively Guide Models with Explanations" - A Reproducibility Study. *Transactions on Machine Learning Research*.
- Traub, M., Becker, F., **Sauter, A.**, Otte, S., & Butz, M. (2024). Loci-segmented: improving scene segmentation learning. In *International Conference on Artificial Neural Networks* (pp. 45–61).
- Sauter, A.**, Zuidema, W., & Kloots, M. D. H. (2026). The Curious Case of Visual Grounding: Different Effects for Speech-and Text-Based Language Encoders. In *ICASSP 2026-2026 IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)* (pp. 17917-17921). IEEE.
- Sauter, A.**, Neplenbroek, V., Vlassopoulos, G., & Bardelloni, G. (2026). Actionable Interpretability for Churn Classification: A Text Bottleneck Model Case Study at a Major Telecom Provider. In *The 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics--Industry Track*.
- Sauter, A.**, & Schirmer, M. (2026). Between Rules and Reality: On the Context Sensitivity of LLM Moral Judgment. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.23114*. Under review at EMNLP 2026.